

would not publish such claims. But it published such ads again. The bench then asked Balkrishna, MD of Patanjali Ayurved, and Ramdev to show cause why they should not be punished for contempt of court. The duo furnished an unconditional apology, and the court let matters rest.

Industry watchers say the court battle has dented the image of Patanjali, Ramdev, and Balkrishna and compelled them to delay plans to list any group firm. Arun Kejriwal, Founder of Kejriwal Research & Investment, says, “These legal actions against them have not reflected very well on Patanjali... Ramdev’s plans to list two to three other group companies on the market are also on the back burner now.”

IMA office-bearers were not available for comment. But Dr Anoop Misra, Chairman of Fortis C-DOC Centre of Excellence Hospital in Delhi, which specialises in managing diabetes and endocrine disorders, blames the Patanjali group for the ambiguity of its research. “Their claims have not been founded on solid science and have faced legal criticism. Most importantly, their claim to ‘cure’ or ‘manage’ type 1 diabetes without insulin, which they have stated several times, can lead to serious problems and even death of such patients,” he says.

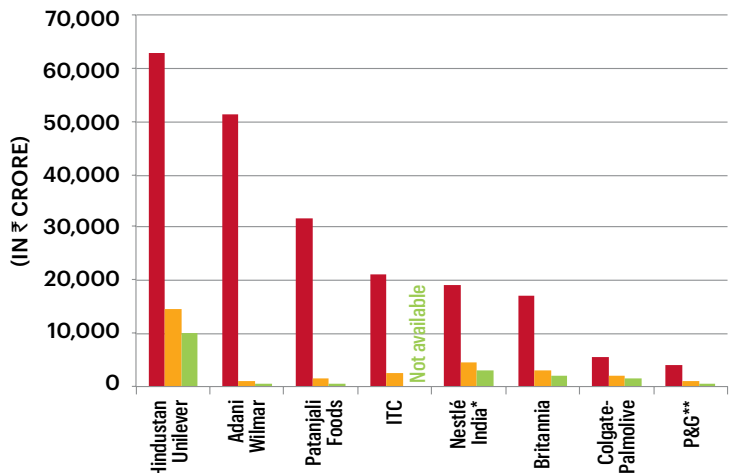
The stakes are high. Experts estimate that the diabetes and pre-diabetes care market in India will reach about \$34 billion in 2026.

Ramdev is unfazed. Taking us around the research facility at Patanjali Research Institute (part of the Patanjali Research Foundation) he says its research facilities are not only top-notch but the institute has already published dozens of papers in “high-impact” journals worldwide. The institute has four key divisions: drug discovery and development, herbal research, Sanskrit and Ayurveda, and clinical research. “This is the world’s largest institute that researches yoga, Ayurveda and

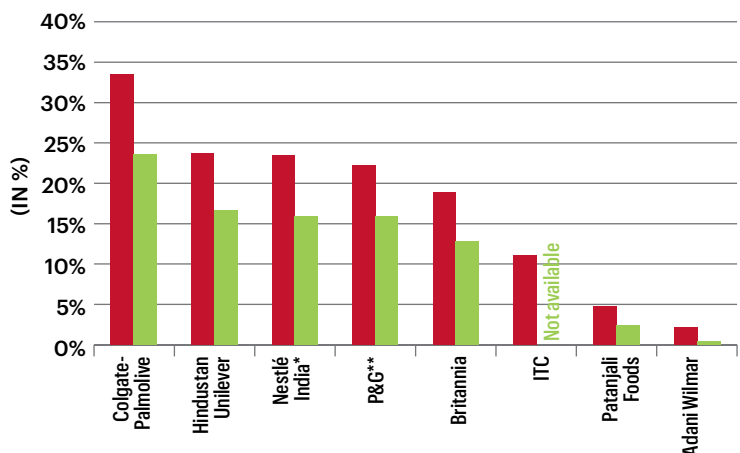


TASK CUT OUT

- Ramdev’s dream to overtake HUL is yet to come true, even though Patanjali has managed to pip MNCs like Colgate, P&G, and Nestlé
- Despite rapid top-line growth, Patanjali’s margins lag its peers’



● REVENUE ● EBITDA ● NET PROFIT



● EBITDA MARGIN ● NET PROFIT MARGIN

NOTE FIGURES ARE FOR FY24; ITC’S NUMBERS ARE FOR ITS NON-CIGARETTE FMCG BUSINESS; *NESTLÉ INDIA’S FY24 NUMBERS ARE FOR JANUARY-DECEMBER 2023; **FOR FY23 (JULY-JUNE)

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